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Software Testing & Debugging

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Test Requirement, Coverage Criteria, and Coverage

- ▶ **Test Requirement (TR):** a specific element of software artifact that a test case must satisfy/cover.
 - ❖ Software artifact can be source code, user manual, API doc, design components (e.g., UML diagrams), GUI, input space, etc.
- ▶ **Coverage Criterion:** a rule or collection of rules to generate test requirements from a software artifact.
- ▶ **Coverage:** Given the set of TRs for a coverage criterion C , a test set T satisfies C (i.e., achieves coverage C) if and only if for any test requirement tr in TR , there is a test case t in T that covers/satisfies tr .

Example: Test Requirements for SC and BC

- ▶ Test Requirement: Think of **test requirements** as **what your tests must cover**, not the tests themselves. In other words:

Test requirements = a checklist of things your tests are required to exercise.

```
public int max(int a, int b) {  
    int result = b;  
    if (a > b) {  
        result = a;  
    }  
    return result;  
}
```

TRs for SC:

1. int result = b;
2. if (a > b) {
3. result = a;
4. return result;

TRs for BC:

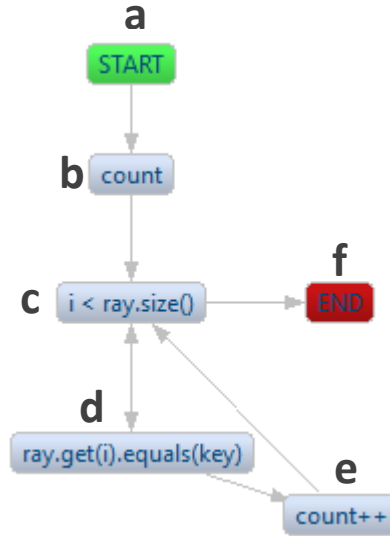
1. True branch of if (a > b)
2. False branch of if (a <= b)

Example: Path Coverage Criterion

```
public static int countOf(ArrayList<Integer> ray, int key) {  
    int count = 0;  
    for (int i = 0; i < ray.size(); ++i) {  
        if (ray.get(i).equals(key)) {  
            count++;  
        }  
    }  
    return count;  
}
```

// Tests

```
List ray0 = new ArrayList<Integer>();  
List ray1 = new ArrayList<Integer>();  
ray1.add(2);  
countOf(ray0, 2); // abcf  
countOf(ray1, 1); // abcdcf  
countOf(ray1, 2); // abcdecf
```



Paths to cover:

abcf
abcdcf
abcdecf

Test requirements

More Definitions

- ▶ **Minimal Test Set:** Given a set of test requirements TR and a test set T , T is minimal if removing any single test case from T will cause T to no longer satisfy all test requirements in TR .
- ▶ **Minimum Test Set:** A test set T that satisfies all test requirements in TR is minimum if there exists no smaller test set that can also satisfy all test requirements in TR .
- ▶ **Coverage Level:** Given test set T and test requirements set TR , assume that T covers/satisfies x number of test requirements in TR . The coverage level of T is: $\frac{x}{|TR|}$

Test Requirement Infeasibility

- ▶ Some test requirements may be infeasible, i.e., can never be satisfied.
- ▶ **Example:** unreachable code, thus not possible to achieve statement or branch coverage → infeasible test requirement

```
if (x < 0) {  
    // do some stuff  
}  
else if (x < -2) {  
    // do some other stuff  
}
```

Ways to Leverage Coverage Criteria

- ▶ 1: directly derive test cases to achieve coverage
 - ❖ Systematic
 - ❖ Not always easy/straightforward/possible
 - ❖ May not be always possible to automate
- ▶ 2: derive test cases and measure coverage level
 - ❖ Less systematic
 - ❖ Easier/more straightforward to perform
 - ❖ (The more) common practice in the industry

How to Utilize Coverage Criteria?

- ▶ 1: directly derive test cases to achieve coverage



Generator, i.e., “Test Generation” tools

- ▶ 2: derive test cases and measure coverage level:



Recognizer, i.e., “Coverage Analysis” tools

Important Question

Given a coverage criterion C , how do you compare 90% coverage level to 100% coverage level ? Does this mean the former is 10% less effective in revealing faults?

Subsumption

How to compare different coverage criteria against each other?

How to decide if one coverage criterion is stronger/weaker than another one?



Subsumption: A test criterion C1 subsumes C2 if and only if every set of test cases that satisfies criterion C1 also satisfies C2

Example: Branch Coverage (BC) subsumes Statement Coverage (SC)

Question

Assume coverage criterion $C1$ subsumes coverage criteria $C2$. $T1$ is a test set that satisfies $C1$ on program P and $T2$ is another test set that satisfies $C2$ on P . It can be concluded that $T1$ detects at least as many faults in P as $T2$ does.

True or False? Justify your answer.

Advantages of Criteria-based Testing

- ▶ Maximize the “bang for the buck”
 - ❖ Fewer tests that are more effective at finding faults
- ▶ Comprehensive test set with minimal overlap
- ▶ “Traceability” from software artifacts to tests
- ▶ A “stopping rule” for testing
- ▶ Lend themselves well to “automation”

Question

Any downsides to (or concerns with!) *criteria-based testing*?

Limitations of Coverage Criteria

- ▶ Might not be easy/straightforward to generate all the test requirements
- ▶ Might not be easy/straightforward to generate test cases that satisfy the generated test requirements
- ▶ Might still be very costly to achieve
- ▶ **Most important:** *what is the correlation, if any, between a coverage criterion satisfaction and its fault detection ability?*

Question

Suppose that coverage criterion C1 subsumes coverage criterion C2. Further suppose that test set T1 satisfies C1 and on program P test set T2 satisfies C2, also on P.

1. Does T1 necessarily satisfy C2? Explain.
2. Does T2 necessarily satisfy C1? Explain.
3. If P contains a fault, and T2 reveals the fault, T1 does not necessarily also reveal the fault. Explain

Combinatorial Coverage Criteria

- ▶ We already discussed equivalence partitioning (EP) technique when we talked about Blackbox testing
- ▶ We learned how to do EP on a domain
 - ❖ e.g., domain is integer values → negative, zero, positive
- ▶ In practice though, oftentimes we have several input/output domain to work with
 - ❖ e.g., a function that has more than one input parameter

We need to work with combinations of equivalence blocks

Example

```
/**
 * Count the number of occurrences of a target value in an ArrayList
 * @param ray the ArrayList instance
 * @param key the target value
 * @return count of occurrences
 */
public static int countOf(ArrayList<Integer> ray, int key) {
    int count = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < ray.size(); ++i) {
        if (ray.get(i).equals(key)) {
            count++;
        }
    }
    return count;
}
```

All Combinations Coverage

All Combinations (ACoC) : All combinations of blocks from all characteristics must be used.

countOf example with the following blocks:

- | | |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| A. ArrayList null | 1. key negative |
| B. ArrayList empty | 2. key zero |
| C. ArrayList size 1 | 3. key positive |
| D. ArrayList size > 1 | |

Test requirements for ACoC would include all possible combinations of the blocks:

(A, 1), (A, 2), ..., (B, 1), ..., (D, 3)

Each Choice Coverage

Each Choice Coverage (ECC) : One value from each block for each characteristic must be used in at least one test case.

countOf example with the following blocks:

- | | |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| A. ArrayList null | 1. key negative |
| B. ArrayList empty | 2. key zero |
| C. ArrayList size 1 | 3. key positive |
| D. ArrayList size > 1 | |

Test requirements for ECC would be:

(A, 1), (B, 2), (C, 3), (D, 1)

Pair-Wise Coverage

Pair-Wise Coverage (PWC) : A value from each block for each characteristic must be combined with a value from every block for each of the other characteristics.

PWC (in simple terms): cover every possible combination of **two input parameters** at a time

Assume we have three partitions with the following blocks:

[A, B], [1, 2, 3], and [x, y]

Test requirements for PWC would be:

(A, 1, x) (B, 1, y)

(A, 2, x) (B, 2, y)

(A, 3, x) (B, 3, y)

(A, 1, y) (B, 1, x)

t-Wise Coverage

t-Wise Coverage (TWC) : A value from each block for each group of t characteristics must be combined.

TWC (in simple terms): cover every possible combination of **t input parameters** at a time

Assume we have three partitions with the following blocks:

[A, B], [1, 2, 3], and [x, y]

Test values for 3-wise coverage would be the same as ACoC, why?

Base Choice Coverage

Base Choice Coverage (BCC) : A base choice block is chosen for each characteristic, and a base test is formed by using the base choice for each characteristic. Subsequent tests are chosen by holding all but one base choice constant and using each non-base choice in each of the other characteristics.

Assume we have three partitions with the following blocks where A, 1, and x are base choices:

[A, B], [1, 2, 3], and [x, y]

Test values for BCC coverage would be:

(A, 1, x) ← base test

(B, 1, x)

(A, 2, x)

(A, 3, x)

(A, 1, y)

Base Choice Selection

- ▶ “base choice” essentially corresponds to the “default” choice for a block
- ▶ Base choice should be feasible (i.e., executable)
- ▶ Base choices usually take the “happy path”
 - ❖ E.g., base choice block for “n” is positive values

```
public static int factorial(int n) {  
    int res = 1, i;  
    for (i = 2; i <= n; i++)  
        res *= i;  
    return res;  
}
```

Multiple Choice Coverage

Multiple Base Choice Coverage (MBCC) : At least one, and possibly more, base choice blocks are chosen for each characteristic, and base tests are formed by using each base choice for each characteristic at least once. Subsequent tests are chosen by holding all but one base choice constant for each base test and using each non-base choice in each of the other characteristics.

Relevant Reads & Resources

- ▶ Recommended Textbooks:

- ❖ Introduction to Software Testing, 2nd Edition: ch5 and ch6



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